

COMPREHENSIVE KNOWLEDGE BASE

Driving License Services in Tanzania

Responsible Authority: Tanzania Revenue Authority (TRA), in coordination with the Tanzania Police Force Traffic Division

Primary Digital Portal: TRA Taxpayer Portal — taxpayer.tra.go.tz

Reference Legal Framework: Road Traffic Act, Cap. 168

1. General Overview

A Tanzanian driving licence is an official authorization permitting a qualified person to drive specified categories of motor vehicles on public roads. The licensing process involves identity verification, learner authorization where applicable, driver training, testing, medical fitness requirements where applicable, payment of prescribed charges, and issuance or renewal of the driving licence.

This knowledge base covers learner permits, first-time licences, renewals, class additions, replacements, foreign-licence conversion, testing, payments, troubleshooting, special cases and chatbot handling rules.

Driving-licence procedures, fees, age requirements, validity periods and portal workflows may change. Current requirements should be confirmed through official TRA and Traffic Police channels before an applicant relies on a particular amount, deadline or procedure.

2. Service Categories

2.1 First-Time Learner's Permit

Initial authorization allowing an applicant to learn and practice driving under the conditions imposed by law and the applicable learner-permit rules.

2.2 First-Time Full Driving Licence

Issuance of a full driving licence after the applicant satisfies training, testing, identity, medical and other applicable requirements.

2.3 Driving Licence Renewal

Renewal of an expiring or expired licence, subject to applicable validity, medical and compliance requirements.

2.4 Class Addition / Extension

Adding an additional vehicle class to an existing licence after completing the required training and testing for that class.

2.5 Lost, Stolen or Damaged Licence Replacement

Replacement of a licence card that has been lost, stolen, destroyed or damaged beyond usable condition.

2.6 Foreign Driving Licence Conversion

Process for converting an eligible foreign driving licence into a Tanzanian licence, subject to verification and applicable immigration and licensing rules.

2.7 Licence Information Update

Correction or update of relevant driver information where the responsible authority permits amendment.

2.8 Driver Record / Licence Number Retrieval

Retrieving an existing licence number or driver record through official systems or an authorized licensing office.

3. Learner's Permit Requirements

- Valid NIDA National Identification Number or NIDA identification, where required.
- Individual TIN where required by the current TRA process.
- Proof of age and identity.
- Medical fitness evidence where required.
- Any prescribed photographs or supporting documents.
- Payment of the applicable learner-permit charge.

The exact minimum age depends on the vehicle class and current law. The chatbot should not treat one age as applicable to every class.

4. Full Driving Licence Requirements

- Valid learner's permit where required.
- Completion certificate from a recognized/accredited driving school where applicable.
- Successful completion of required theoretical and practical Traffic Police testing.
- Valid identity information.
- Medical fitness certificate where required for the applicant or licence class.
- Proof of payment of applicable charges.
- Any additional documents requested by the licensing authority.

5. Renewal Requirements

- Existing driving licence, where available.
- NIDA identification or NIN as required.
- TIN where required by the current TRA workflow.
- Current medical fitness certificate where applicable.
- Proof of payment.
- Additional documentation where the licence has been expired for an extended period or the driver's circumstances require further review.

Renewal requirements can differ depending on the driver's age, licence class, expiry status and applicable rules.

6. Class Extension / Addition

- Existing valid driving licence.
- Evidence of required training for the requested class.
- Successful Traffic Police test or endorsement for the relevant class.
- Medical fitness evidence where applicable.

- Proof of payment.
- Any additional documentation required for commercial or heavy vehicle classes.

Different vehicle classes can have different minimum ages, medical requirements, training standards and testing requirements.

7. Lost, Stolen or Damaged Licence Replacement

- Police loss report for a lost or stolen card where required.
- Affidavit or other declaration of loss where required.
- NIDA identification and TIN where required.
- Existing licence number or driver record information if available.
- Damaged physical licence for damaged-card replacement, where applicable.
- Proof of payment.

A replacement process does not normally create a new driving entitlement; it replaces evidence of an existing licence subject to verification.

8. Foreign Driving Licence Conversion

- Original valid foreign driving licence.
- Valid passport or accepted identity document.
- Immigration/residence documentation where applicable.
- Work permit or other authorization where relevant.
- Official translation where the licence is not in an accepted language.
- Verification from the issuing authority or embassy where requested.
- Medical or testing evidence where required by Tanzanian rules.
- Proof of payment.

Holding a foreign driving licence does not automatically guarantee conversion. Eligibility depends on the licence's validity, issuing jurisdiction, vehicle class, verification and Tanzanian legal requirements.

9. Age and Eligibility

Age requirements depend on the licence or vehicle class. Light private-vehicle licensing and commercial/heavy classes may have different minimum ages and conditions. Applicants should use the requirement applicable to the exact class requested.

- Identity and date of birth must be accurately recorded.
- Underage applications should not be submitted for classes for which the applicant does not meet the legal minimum.
- Commercial and heavy-vehicle applicants may face additional requirements.
- The authority may require medical or professional-driver qualifications for particular classes.

10. Medical Fitness

Driving safety can require assessment of eyesight, physical ability and other medical factors. Medical requirements can vary by licence class and applicant circumstances.

- Use an appropriately recognized medical practitioner or facility where certification is required.
- Disclose relevant limitations honestly.
- Where a disability affects driving controls, the authority may assess whether adapted controls or conditions can safely permit driving.
- A medical certificate should be current and genuine.

The chatbot must not diagnose medical fitness or declare a person medically fit. It should direct the applicant to the authorized medical assessment process.

11. Driving School and Training

Applicants for a first full licence generally undergo formal driver training before testing. Training should be obtained from an institution recognized or accepted by the responsible authorities.

- Theory and road-safety instruction.
- Vehicle-control and practical driving training.
- Traffic rules and road signs.
- Defensive-driving principles.
- Preparation for the required Traffic Police test.

The chatbot should not claim that a particular school is accredited unless that status has been verified through an authoritative current source.

12. Traffic Police Testing

The testing process may include theoretical and practical assessment. Results must be recorded or recognized by the relevant authority before a full licence or class endorsement can be issued.

- Theory examination.
- Practical driving assessment.
- Vehicle-class-specific assessment where applicable.
- Identity verification before testing.
- Official recording of the result.

Passing a driving test does not by itself guarantee immediate card issuance if other requirements, payments, verification or compliance checks remain outstanding.

13. Fees and Payment

The supplied reference lists the following charges, but these amounts should be treated as reference figures rather than permanent tariff guarantees:

- Learner's permit: TZS 10,000.
- Driving test: TZS 20,000.
- New/renewed smart-card licence: TZS 70,000.
- Class extension: TZS 40,000.
- Lost/damaged licence replacement: TZS 70,000.

Payment is described as being made through a government control number generated through the TRA taxpayer portal or the applicable official process, with mobile-money and participating bank channels supported through government payment infrastructure.

Before payment, applicants should verify the amount, control number, service description and beneficiary information shown in the official system.

14. End-to-End Learner Permit Workflow

1. Confirm eligibility for the requested vehicle class.
2. Prepare NIDA/TIN and other required information.
3. Access the official TRA service channel.
4. Complete the learner-permit application.
5. Provide medical or supporting documents where required.
6. Generate the official payment control number.
7. Pay through an authorized channel.
8. Confirm payment status.
9. Receive or collect the learner authorization according to the current procedure.
10. Begin training under the conditions attached to the learner permit.

15. End-to-End Full Licence Workflow

11. Complete the required learner period and driver training.
12. Attend the required Traffic Police theory and practical tests.
13. Obtain a passing result.
14. Confirm that the test result is recorded against the applicant's driver record.
15. Apply for the full driving licence through the applicable TRA process.
16. Generate and pay the required control number.
17. Attend the licensing office for identity/photo/biometric verification if required.
18. Complete card production and issuance procedures.
19. Collect the licence after the authority confirms it is ready.

16. Renewal Workflow

20. Check licence expiry and applicable renewal eligibility.
21. Prepare the existing licence and required identification.
22. Obtain medical certification where required.
23. Access the official renewal service.
24. Submit the requested information.
25. Generate and pay the applicable control number.
26. Resolve any outstanding compliance issue or query.
27. Complete photo/biometric verification where required.
28. Collect or receive the renewed licence according to the current procedure.

17. Class Extension Workflow

29. Confirm the desired vehicle class and eligibility.
30. Complete required training.
31. Sit the relevant Traffic Police test.

32. Confirm successful endorsement.
33. Submit the class-extension application.
34. Pay the prescribed charge.
35. Complete any required biometric/card update.
36. Collect the updated licence.

18. Replacement Workflow

37. Report loss or theft to the Police where required.
38. Obtain any required affidavit/declaration.
39. Gather NIDA/TIN and existing licence information.
40. Apply for replacement through the official channel.
41. Pay the replacement charge.
42. Complete identity verification.
43. Receive the replacement card.

19. Smart Card and Biometric Verification

Modern driving licences may contain security and machine-readable features. The licensing process can therefore involve a live photograph, fingerprints, digital signature or other identity checks depending on the current system.

The chatbot should not claim a specific biometric technology is always captured unless the current official procedure confirms it.

20. Edge Cases and Special Scenarios

20.1 Underage Applicants

Applicants who do not meet the minimum age for the requested licence class are not eligible for that class. Age should be determined from the authoritative identity record.

20.2 Long-Expired Licences

A licence that has been expired for an extended period may require additional verification, testing or a fresh application rather than an ordinary renewal. The exact treatment should be confirmed with the licensing authority.

20.3 Physical Disability or Adapted Vehicles

A physical disability does not automatically mean a person cannot drive. The relevant authorities may assess functional ability and, where permitted, authorize conditions or vehicle adaptations that allow safe driving.

20.4 Professional and Heavy Vehicle Drivers

Heavy, commercial or professional driving can involve additional age, medical, training, testing or professional requirements. The chatbot should identify the requested class before giving requirements.

20.5 Foreign Nationals

Foreign nationals should be assessed based on their immigration status, foreign licence, intended driving activity and the applicable Tanzanian conversion rules. A TIN, residence document or work permit does not itself constitute a Tanzanian driving licence.

20.6 Citizens Returning from Abroad

A Tanzanian citizen holding a foreign licence may need to use the foreign-licence verification/conversion process rather than simply exchanging the card. The responsible authority determines eligibility.

21. Outstanding Traffic Fines

Unpaid traffic penalties may interfere with some licensing transactions where the official system places a compliance hold on the driver's record. The applicant should verify outstanding penalties and follow the authorized payment or dispute process.

The chatbot should not state that every licence transaction is automatically blocked by every type of fine unless the current official system confirms that rule.

22. Traffic Test Result Not Showing Online

If a passed test is not reflected in the digital record, the applicant should retain the official test receipt or result and contact the relevant Traffic Police or licensing office for verification and synchronization.

- Keep the original test evidence.
- Check that the correct NIN/TIN/licence profile was used.
- Ask the testing office to confirm submission.
- Request manual reconciliation if the official system requires it.
- Do not pay for a second test solely because an electronic record is delayed without first confirming the status.

23. Lost Licence Number

If the physical card is lost and the licence number is unknown, the applicant should use an official driver-record lookup or visit the responsible licensing office with identity documents. The chatbot should not invent or expose a licence number.

24. Payment Problems

- Confirm the control number belongs to the intended driving-licence service.
- Keep the payment receipt and transaction reference.
- Allow reasonable time for payment reconciliation.
- Contact the responsible authority if the payment remains pending.
- Do not make duplicate payments without confirmation.

25. Name or Identity Mismatch

A mismatch between NIDA, TIN, Traffic Police and driving-licence records can prevent processing. The applicant should identify which record is incorrect and correct the underlying record through the responsible authority.

- Do not create a second identity record to bypass the error.
- Do not submit altered documents.
- Carry original supporting documents when attending an office.
- Request formal correction or reconciliation.

26. Licence Card Not Ready

A successful application or payment does not necessarily mean that the physical card is immediately available. Applicants should use the official tracking method or contact the responsible office to confirm production and collection status.

27. Licence Expiry and Driving Legality

Drivers should monitor the expiry date printed or associated with the licence and renew according to the applicable legal procedure. A person should not assume that an expired licence remains valid merely because a renewal application has been submitted.

28. Privacy and Security

- Protect NIDA numbers, TINs, licence numbers and application references.
- Do not share portal passwords or OTPs.
- Use official government websites and offices.
- Do not send identity documents to unknown agents or unofficial social-media accounts.
- Verify control numbers before payment.
- Keep payment receipts and official application references securely.

29. Chatbot Decision Flow

44. Ask whether the user needs a learner permit, first licence, renewal, class extension, replacement or foreign-licence conversion.
45. Identify the requested vehicle class.
46. Determine the applicant's age and nationality/residency status where relevant.
47. Determine whether the applicant already holds a learner permit or driving licence.
48. Check whether the request concerns loss, damage, expiry, a new class or foreign conversion.
49. Provide only the documents relevant to that pathway.
50. Explain the application, testing, payment and issuance stages.
51. Flag medical, professional-driver and heavy-vehicle requirements where applicable.
52. Treat fees, portal features, validity periods and deadlines as time-sensitive.
53. For legal disputes, medical fitness decisions, licensing refusals or complex cases, direct the applicant to the responsible authority.

30. Frequently Asked Questions

What is a learner's permit?

It is an authorization that allows an eligible learner to practice driving under the conditions imposed by the applicable law and permit.

Can I get a full licence without training?

Applicants should complete the training and testing required for the requested class. The exact requirements depend on the class and current rules.

Can I add another vehicle class later?

Yes, where eligible, through the class-extension/addition process and the required training and testing.

What if I lose my licence?

Report the loss where required, obtain supporting loss documentation, apply for replacement and pay the applicable charge.

Can a foreign licence be used permanently in Tanzania?

Not necessarily. Foreign licences are subject to applicable recognition, duration and conversion rules.

Does a TIN equal a driving licence?

No. A TIN is a taxpayer identifier; a driving licence is a legal authorization to drive specified vehicle classes.

What if my test result is missing online?

Keep your official test evidence and ask the testing/licensing office to verify and synchronize the record.

Can a person with a physical disability drive?

Potentially, depending on functional ability, medical assessment, vehicle adaptations and the conditions authorized by the responsible authority.

Can I drive after my licence expires because I have applied for renewal?

Do not assume so. Confirm the legal status and any temporary authorization with the responsible authority.

Are the listed fees permanent?

No. Fees and payment procedures can change, so the current official tariff should be confirmed before payment.

31. Applicant Checklist

Before Applying

- Identify the exact service needed.
- Identify the vehicle class.
- Confirm age eligibility.
- Check NIDA/TIN details.
- Prepare required documents.
- Check whether medical certification is required.
- Confirm the current fee and payment process.

During the Process

- Use the official portal or licensing office.

- Enter information accurately.
- Upload clear and genuine documents.
- Keep the application/reference number.
- Attend required training and testing.
- Keep payment receipts.

Before Collection

- Confirm the application has been approved.
- Confirm payment has been reconciled.
- Check collection instructions.
- Carry original identification.
- Inspect the issued card for correct names, licence number, classes and expiry information.

32. Data-Quality and AI Safety Rules

- Do not invent current fees, age thresholds, validity periods or processing times.
- Do not guarantee same-day issuance.
- Do not guarantee that a particular driving school is accredited without current verification.
- Do not make medical fitness decisions.
- Do not advise users to drive with an expired licence unless official rules explicitly permit it.
- Do not confuse a learner permit with a full licence.
- Do not confuse TIN registration with driving entitlement.
- Do not advise applicants to falsify documents or bypass identity checks.
- Do not request passwords, OTPs or unnecessary financial information.
- For disputed penalties, refusals, medical issues and legal interpretation, refer to the appropriate authority.

33. Core Information Summary

Category	Key Information
Responsible Authorities	TRA in coordination with Tanzania Police Force Traffic Division
Primary Portal	TRA Taxpayer Portal — taxpayer.tra.go.tz
Legal Framework	Road Traffic Act, Cap. 168
Learner Permit	Initial authorization for supervised driving practice
Full Licence	Issued after applicable training, testing and verification
Renewal	Updates an existing licence subject to current requirements
Class Extension	Adds eligible vehicle classes after required training/testing
Replacement	Reissues a lost, stolen or damaged licence
Foreign Conversion	Converts an eligible foreign licence subject to verification
Payment	Official government control number and authorized payment channels
Key Risks	Identity mismatch, missing test results, unpaid penalties, expired licences and incomplete documentation